

Should Interactive Stories be classified as Games?

A critical Review of the Adventure Game Genre

The adventure game genre has evolved from time to time, which leads to more new forms of storytelling and interactivity and a debate on this genre which is whether “Interactive stories” can be classified as a game. This essay aims to give the answer to the question above by analysing the genre. This report would be consisting the recommended game list and some other examples

Define Interactive Story:

Is where the player get to experience a story and make choices which would change the outcome of the story. These choices can be in form of decisions, dialogue options, actions, allowing the character to shape and form the narrative as it progress

Some argue that interactive stories should be classified as games, but some disagree, in order to get into a conclusion we must take a look at some honourable mentions:

The first game that would be introduced in this essay would be “Emily is Away”(EIA). EIA is an Indie Game, this indie game utilizes the concept of interactive storytelling genre, at first glance player can see a simulated chat interface, where the player would start a conversation with a fictional character name Emily. The game’s story revealed through the dialogue choices and interaction made by the player, allowing players to shape the story’s ending. according to many people including my classmates, the game’s community on steam and on social media EIA is a game that hanging on the line between interactive storytelling and game.

Next honourable mention is “The Supper”. The Supper(TS) in contrast is a short indie puzzle game that shows more of the story of the game through the atmosphere. In this game, the player gets to play as a chef named Appleton, serving gruesome meals to some creepy looking guests while trying so solve puzzle. The game’s pixelated art style enhances its eerie charm. The things that makes this game so special is the ability to mix the elements of horror and puzzle-solving. The game challenges the player to think critically and creatively to progress. The story of TS unravels by each meals the player prepare for the guests, and by each meals more plot twists and secrets are revealed. TS with just a short playtime it still be able to deliver such a rich and memorable narrative.

The last game is “The Stanley Parable Demo”. TSPD is also an indie game that mainly focus on its narrative, allowing players to put themselves in its bizarre storyline. TSPD offers players a taste of its unique storytelling which would mess with your head. The players travel through the game with a weird voice speaking to you. TSPD tricks you into making choices that leads to strange results. In this game players are the one whos in control and its all about what the player decides. What make this game so unique is how it breaks the rule of regular games by letting the players explore and make choices that matters to the storyline.

All and all, interactive stories in adventure games are getting more and more popular. From those 3 games that I've mentioned above, I would say that in my opinion, Interactive Stories can also be considered as games.

Enemy design for an Action Game

Iron Snout Enemy 1

Name: Knight
Health: 5



a little bigger than other standard wolf enemies but he wears armor with two knives on each hand. He will appear once you killed more than 15 enemies

introduction: these are very strong and well trained knights, specialize in close-range combat, their attacks are very slow but also very dangerous

Gameplay: more durable and slower than other standard enemies, he will throw 1 knife and then use the other one for close range combat, the throwing knife would be 1.25 times faster than standard throwing knife. the close range attack would deal 2 damage but the attack would be 0.5 times slower compare to normal wolf enemy attack. And since the wear armours, the knock back would be less efficient

Knight Wolf are mid-level enemies, providing a little challenge to the game

Enemy 2

Name: Ninja Hound



Health 2

same size as the other wolf enemies, he wears ninja clothes with a shuriken and a Katana. he will appear once you killed more than 50 enemies

Introduction: these are highly trained Ninja Canines, specialize in long-range attacks. Their speed and agility make them formidable

Gameplay: fast and agile, can jump, dash, and smoke teleport from left to right and right to left once each move mostly to confuse the player choosing which side to strike. he will throw a shuriken for each time he jump/dash/teleport. when he closed the range between you and him, he will attack with the katana which would be 3 damage each slash, his close range attack would be as fast as a standard wolf enemy

Ninja Hound is a very difficult enemy to deal with but since you've made it to 50 kills maybe you should try something harder

both ninja hound and knight wolf will cause some trouble to the player depending on how far the player have made it into the game, the better they prove themselves to be, the stronger and harder the enemies become

Relic Hunter Zero

Name: Damniel



Alias: The Celestial Guardian

Species: Celestial

Gender: male

Age: Unknown

In Game info:

Health: 5

Shield: 5

Melee: 7

Speed: 3

Stamina: 5

Biography: Damniel is an ancient guardian, with a duty of protecting the relics from falling into the wrong hands. Throughout Centuries, He remains as a formidable defender. The celestial blood running inside his veins grants him some unique powers.

Personality: Wise and noble as a proof of being alive since forever, Damniel carries the weight of his duty with determination. His dedication to guarding the relics fuels his every action.

Gameplay mechanic: Damniel excels in close range combat but due to his spear, his range would be some what wider than the average close range combat characters, his ultimate ability, "Celestial Wrath" is when he can summon an infinite amount of spear to throw at his enemies for a period of time, this ultimate move would increase his range by 3 to 4 times

Mechanics Designs for 3 different game Genres

1. Mechanics for "You Have To Win The Game":

For this retro-style, pixelated game I personally think "Gravitational manipulation" would be perfect. This mechanic would revolve around the player's ability to use their brain to manipulate whether the gravity would pull the players up or down, left or right

Gameplay Breakdown:

The player will be spawned with a device that will grant them the ability to change the gravity direction:

1. Gravity Inversion: Player can change the direction of gravity, which allows the player to walk on walls or ceilings
2. Weigh Change: Player can change the weigh of their body which allows them to move faster, jump higher in a short period of time



How would this mechanic improve the gameplay:

1. More strategic approach: player will need to strategize how and when to change the direction of gravity to dodge enemies and traps.
2. More Challenges: with Gravity Manipulation the game can be more tricky which triggers the player to be more flexible to be able to adapt to the game.
3. More creative gameplay: flipping up and down is fun but when the player gets the hang of it, they could be very creative with it

Personally I think that Gravity Manipulation not only aligns with the game theme but also improves the gameplay by offering a new approach to the challenge

2. Cube Escape Paradox

For this puzzle game, I came up with a time travel mechanic. Its not literally time travel but the player would get to find and solve puzzles like usual and then when the player solve the puzzle they would get to experience the time when the scene took place and receive more clues for later puzzles.

Gameplay breakdown:

1. The player solve puzzle A then they fell as sleep and dream about when the crime scene takes place
2. By solving many puzzles and many black out visions from the past the killer and the case would be revealed

How this improve the gameplay:

1. Adds depth and replayability to the game
2. Adds lore and backstory to the game